Grade 8 - English First Additional Language

Mid-Year Exam - Term 2 (CAPS Aligned)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Time: 1 hour	**Total:** 40 marks

This question paper consists of the following sections:

Section A: Reading Comprehension (15)

Section B: Language in Context (15)

Section C: Response to Literature (10)



visit twinkl.co.za

Section A: Reading Comprehension

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Human Rights Day is celebrated in South Africa on 21 March each year. This important day commemorates the Sharpeville Massacre of 1960, when peaceful protesters were killed for standing up against unfair laws. Today, Human Rights Day reminds people of the importance of dignity, equality and freedom that everyone should have.

Human rights are basic rights that apply to all people, regardless of race, gender, religion or background. These rights include the right to education, the right to freedom of speech, the right to safety and the right to be treated fairly. In South Africa, these rights are protected by the Constitution, which was introduced after the end of apartheid.

Although human rights are written into law, they are not always respected in everyday life. Many people still experience discrimination, poverty and violence. For example, some children struggle to access quality education, while others live in communities where they feel unsafe. When human rights are ignored, it affects not only individuals but also society as a whole.

Schools play an important role in teaching learners about human rights. By learning about fairness, respect and responsibility, young people can help create a more just society. Human Rights Day encourages citizens to reflect on past struggles and to think about the ways they can protect the rights of others in the present.

Understanding human rights is not only about remembering history; it is also about making choices that show respect for others every day. When people stand up for what is right, they help build a future where everyone can live with dignity and hope.



visit twinkl.co.za

Question 1:

Multiple Choice: Circle only the correct letter.

1.1. What is the main purpose of Human Rights Day? (1)

a) To celebrate public holidays

b) To remember a historical event and promote human rights

c) To protest against schools

d) To create new laws

1.2. Which event is Human Rights Day linked to? (1)

a) The Soweto Uprising

b) The Sharpeville Massacre

c) Freedom Day

d) Youth Day

1.3. Which right is mentioned in the passage? (1)

a) The right to vote

b) The right to own property

c) The right to education

d) The right to travel

visit twinkl.co.za

1.4. Read the following statement and say whether it is True or False. If false, correct the statement:

Human rights apply only to certain groups of people. (1)

1.5. Give two examples of human rights mentioned in the passage. (2)

1.6. Why are human rights sometimes not respected in everyday life? (2)

1.7. Explain how schools can help promote human rights. (2)

1.8. Identify whether the following statement is a fact or an opinion. Justify your response:

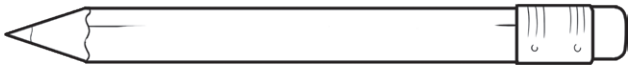
Schools play an important role in teaching learners about human rights. (2)

visit twinkl.co.za

1.9. In your opinion, why is it important for young people to learn about human rights? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

1.10. Find a word in the passage that means the same as fairness. (1)

Total: 15



visit twinkl.co.za

Section B: Language in Context

Question 2:

2.1. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:

*Human rights are **protected** by the Constitution.* (1)

2.2. Rewrite the sentence in the past tense:

People respect human rights. (1)

2.3. Choose the correct word to complete the sentence:

Everyone should be treated (equal / equally). (1)

2.4. Rewrite the sentence in the passive voice:

The Constitution protects human rights. (2)

---

visit twinkl.co.za

2.5. Identify the subject in the sentence:

Schools teach learners about fairness and respect. (1)

2.6. Combine the sentences using the conjunction 'because':

Human rights are important. They protect people from unfair treatment. (2)

2.7. Give an antonym (opposite) for the word: *dignity* (1)

2.8. Identify the type of sentence:

Why should we respect the rights of others? (1)

2.9. Correct the spelling error in the following sentence:

Discrimination affects many comunities. (1)

visit twinkl.co.za

2.10. Insert the correct punctuation:

On 21 March South Africans remember human rights day. (2)

_____

2.11. Rewrite the sentence using a modal verb:

People respect the rights of others. (2)

_____

Total: 15



visit twinkl.co.za

Section C: Response to Literature

Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow:



The New Colossus

by Emma Lazarus

Not like the brazen giant of Greek fame,
With conquering limbs astride from land to land;
Here at our sea-washed, sunset gates shall stand
A mighty woman with a torch, whose flame
Is the imprisoned lightning, and her name
Mother of Exiles. From her beacon-hand
Glows world-wide welcome; her mild eyes command
The air-bridged harbor that twin cities frame.
"Keep, ancient lands, your storied pomp!" cries she
With silent lips. "Give me your tired, your poor,
Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free,
The wretched refuse of your teeming shore.
Send these, the homeless, tempest-tost to me,
I lift my lamp beside the golden door!"

visit twinkl.co.za

Glossary:

brazen	bold and without shame
conquering	overcoming and taking control of
Exiles	expel and bar (someone) from their native country
yearning	a feeling of intense longing for something
tempest-tost	pounded or hit repeatedly by storms or difficulties



visit twinkl.co.za

Question 3:

3.1. Who is the speaker in the poem, and who is she speaking for? (2)

3.2. Quote one line from the poem that shows the speaker is welcoming people. (2)

3.3. What does the phrase *'your huddled masses yearning to breathe free'* suggest about the people being described? (2)

3.4. Explain how this poem links to the theme of human rights. (2)

3.5. Do you think the speaker's message is welcoming or rejecting? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

Total: 10

Grand Total: 40

visit twinkl.co.za

Grade 8 - English First Additional Language

Mid-Year Exam - Term 2 (CAPS Aligned)

Answers



SECTION A: Reading Comprehension (15 marks)

1.1. b (1)

1.2. b (1)

1.3. c (1)

1.4. False, human rights apply to all people. (1)

1.5. Any TWO: the right to education, safety, freedom of speech, fair treatment (2)

1.6. Because of discrimination, poverty, violence or lack of awareness (2)

1.7. By teaching respect, fairness and responsibility (2)

1.8. Opinion. It is an opinion because the statement expresses a belief or judgement and cannot be proven true or false with evidence. (2)

1.9. Open-ended; valid reason required

Yes, it is important because young people need to understand their rights and responsibilities so that they can treat others fairly and stand up against injustice. / Learning about human rights helps young people make respectful choices and contribute to a safer and more equal society. (2)

(Any valid reason linked to human rights and supported by a clear explanation should be accepted.)

1.10. Equality / just (1)

visit twinkl.co.za

SECTION B: Language in Context (15 marks)

2.1. Verb (1)

2.2. People respected human rights (1)

2.3. Equally (1)

2.4. Human rights are protected by the Constitution (2)

2.5. Schools (1)

2.6. Human rights are important because they protect people from unfair treatment. (2)

2.7. Indignity / dishonour / disrespect (1)

2.8. Interrogative sentence (accept question sentence) (1)

2.9. Communities (1)

2.10. On 21 March, South Africans remember Human Rights Day. (2)

2.11. People should/must respect the rights of others. (2)

SECTION C: Response to Literature (10 marks)

3.1. The speaker is the 'Mother of Exiles', a symbolic figure representing the Statue of Liberty, and she is speaking for a nation that welcomes immigrants and people seeking freedom. (2)

3.2. Any ONE quoted line showing welcome:

- 'Give me your tired, your poor,'
- 'Send these, the homeless, tempest-tost to me,'
- 'Glows world-wide welcome'

(Any valid quotation) (2)

visit twinkl.co.za

3.3. It suggests that the people are oppressed, suffering and longing for freedom and a better life. (2)

3.4. The poem promotes human rights such as dignity, freedom, safety and equality for all people, especially those who are poor or displaced. (2)

3.5. Welcoming: The speaker invites and accepts people who are suffering and offers them hope and protection.

(Other justified responses are acceptable.) (2)

Grand Total: 40



visit twinkl.co.za